

READING PASSAGE 1

Universal Basic Income: Theory and Evidence

A The study of universal basic income: theory and evidence has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

B The origins of contemporary research in this area can be traced to pioneering studies conducted during the mid-twentieth century. These early investigations, though constrained by the technological and methodological limitations of their era, established foundational principles that continue to inform current scholarship. Successive generations of researchers have built upon these foundations, progressively refining theoretical models and expanding the empirical evidence base through increasingly sophisticated research designs.

C Contemporary research has identified several critical factors that determine outcomes in this domain. The interplay between environmental conditions, technological capabilities, and social organisation creates a complex adaptive system in which small changes can produce disproportionately large effects. Understanding these dynamics requires analytical approaches that move beyond simple cause-and-effect reasoning to embrace the principles of complexity science and systems thinking.

D The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

E The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

F The future trajectory of research in this area will likely be shaped by several converging trends. Advances in computational methods and data science are opening up new analytical possibilities, enabling researchers to detect patterns and test hypotheses at scales that were previously unimaginable. Simultaneously, growing recognition of the importance of interdisciplinary collaboration is breaking down traditional barriers between fields and fostering innovative syntheses of diverse theoretical perspectives.

G The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

Questions 1–2

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 1 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?
- A. too much data collection
 - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
 - C. insufficient government funding
 - D. overly complex statistical methods
- 2 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?
- A. excessive funding
 - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
 - C. public interest
 - D. international collaboration

Question 3

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 3 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

Question 4

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 4 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:
- A. excessive funding
 - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
 - C. public interest
 - D. international collaboration

Questions 5–6

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 5 Case studies have documented the effects of _____ change on the system.
- 6 Researchers used data from more than _____ countries in the landmark study.

Questions 7–8

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 7 Policy-makers have fully implemented all research recommendations.

8 Meta-analyses have confirmed the reliability of the core findings in this field.

Question 9

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 9 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. too much data collection
 - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
 - C. insufficient government funding
 - D. overly complex statistical methods

Question 10

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 10 The author notes that researchers have called for more _____ approaches to investigation.

Question 11

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 11 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. too much data collection
 - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
 - C. insufficient government funding
 - D. overly complex statistical methods

Question 12

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 12 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of _____ years.

Question 13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information
Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information
Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.